

# Under the Bridge -- Red Hot Chili Peppers

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. Full board.

From \*Blood Sugar Sex Magik\* (1991), ~85 BPM.

Flea's part here is famously the opposite of his usual percussive slap style -- warm, restrained, melodic, almost guitar-like. Verses stay quiet and intimate, following the chords under Anthony Kiedis's vocal. Then the outro opens into one of the most cathartic moments in the band's catalog, the choir-backed "under the bridge downtown" swell.

CTL off = the quiet, restrained verse. CTL on = the huge choir-backed outro swell.

## GP-5 settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB.

### NR -- Gate

- THRE: 12
- Always on. Very low threshold -- this tone is clean and quiet from top to bottom, nothing to clean up.

### PRE -- Micro Boost -- On CTL

- Gain: 50
- CTL off: bypassed (verse). CTL on: engaged (outro).
- Verse stays soft and understated. Outro gets a clean push to help the bass swell along with the choir and full band.

### DST -- Off

- No drive anywhere. This is a clean, emotional tone top to bottom -- the opposite of a typical Flea part.

### AMP -- Bellman 59N (Fender 59 Bassman Normal, Clean)

- Gain: 28, PRES: 55, VOL: 65, Bass: 58, Middle: 52, Treble: 48
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- A warm, vintage Fender clean voicing rather than a modern bass amp -- matches how uncharacteristically warm and unadorned this particular Flea performance is. Gain kept low for genuine clean headroom.

### CAB -- User IR 2 (Apg115410)

- VOL: 60
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- Summed Ampeg Heritage B-15 + HLF 410 -- flat, thunderous response that gives this warm tone real body without coloring it further. Works equally well for the quiet verse and the huge outro swell.

### EQ -- Bass EQ 2

- 50Hz: +3, 120Hz: +1, 400Hz: 0, 800Hz: +1, 4.5kHz: +2, VOL: 55
- Always on, same for both CTL states.
- A gentle, mostly-flat curve -- this tone doesn't need aggressive shaping. +3 at 50Hz keeps real low-end weight, +2 at 4.5kHz adds just enough presence to keep the melodic line clear without brightening it past

"warm."

### **MOD -- Off**

- No modulation. This part is plain and direct on the record -- texture would work against its sincerity.

### **DLY -- Off**

- Not used.

### **RVB -- Hall -- On CTL**

- Mix: 32, Decay: 50, Trail: On
- CTL off: bypassed (verse -- dry and intimate). CTL on: engaged (outro).
- Hall, and pushed further than usual (Mix 32, Decay 50) -- this outro is genuinely massive and cathartic, one of the biggest emotional swells in the band's catalog, and it needs a reverb big enough to actually open the space up for that.

### **CAB IR -- Apg115410 (Slot 2)**

- Summed Ampeg Heritage B-15 + HLF 410, confirmed loaded on User IR slot 2. Flat, thunderous response -- a solid, uncolored foundation for a tone built entirely around warmth and restraint rather than aggressive EQ shaping.
- Encoded directly into the `.prst` as a real, active CAB reference (`User IR 2`) -- no manual loading needed for this one.

### **CTL summary**

- **CTL Off -- Verse.** Quiet, warm, restrained. Sits back and follows the chords.
- **CTL On -- Outro.** Boost and a big Hall reverb engage together, opening the tone up to match the choir-backed climax.
- Engage CTL right as the "under the bridge downtown" outro begins, and leave it on through to the end.

### **Full pedalboard (signal chain order)**

#### **1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Bypassed**

- Footswitch off. This melodic line needs a single clean fundamental -- no reason to layer octaves on such a restrained, intimate part.

#### **2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged**

- COMP: 42
- TONE: 50
- LEVEL: 55
- Mode: NORMAL
- Light-to-moderate compression keeps the melodic phrasing smooth without squashing the natural dynamics of the performance. NORMAL mode over TREBLE -- this tone wants warmth, not extra brightness.

### **3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed**

- Footswitch off. No fuzz anywhere near this patch.

### **4. Joyo Tidal Wave -- Engaged**

- Drive: 10
- Blend: 20
- Presence: 50
- Level: 55
- Treble: 50
- Middle: 55
- Bass: 58
- Mid-Frequency: 500Hz
- Bass-Shift: 40Hz
- Cab-Sim (DI out): On
- Ground Lift: On
- Used purely as a clean-leaning tone shaper and DI stage, not an overdrive -- Drive stays low and Blend stays mostly clean. Bass-Shift at 40Hz keeps the low end full and warm rather than tight, matching this song's unhurried, emotional feel.

### **5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed**

- Footswitch off. No chorus -- matches the MOD-off call on the GP-5. Plain, direct, warm tone throughout.

### **6. Valeton GP-5 -- see settings above.**